

During his long school holiday, Jason decided to explore the prospects of venturing into farming. With 4,000 shillings in savings; he relocated to the family farm, occupied the shed house there, and tilled some land and planted traditional greens, kale and spinach. When the vegetables were ready, Jason started looking for customers. He discovered the local market where whole sale trade took place between 4am and 6am. The challenge he faced in pursuing this approach was that it cost a lot for them to transport the product. The other alternative was to sell the produce at a discount to brokers who frequently visited the farm. The third option was to retail the produce to consumers either directly from the farm or through a small retail shop.

Jason had a few customers that stopped by the farm for their weekly supplies. One such customer is Maria, she is a conscious consumer looking for organic produce and willing to pay a premium for food she could trust. She saw Jason's twitter post about the farm and decided to check it out. Jason recently connected Maria with a farmer who supplies her with Milk and Eggs every Friday. The farmer was more than happy to give Jason a small commission as an appreciation for the business.

In reviewing his journal, Jason realizes that he has documented a large number of farms, all growing vegetables that take a short time to grow and are often in demand. Most farmers were farming on family land that they could not sell and did not have money to pursue alternative ventures. He differentiated farmers between those planting products in greenhouses and those farming outdoors. Greenhouse farmers tended to have visually appealing products than those farming outdoors. Jason now understood that most buyers were price sensitive. Fresh produce has a short shelf life and customers try to compensate for potential waste by looking for good deals. Customers normally switch between buying directly from the farms, or market or supermarket. Customers care about quality of produce and ease of access.

Jason has also learnt that farming as a business is not regulated. Anyone with access to land and water can start farming. With so much land left unfarmed, even a small patch can be a source of alternative income. He is considering whether to register a business or to shelf the farming idea and look for a new idea.

Jason thinks that he can come up with an innovative solution that connects customers like Maria with farmers growing organic produce. This would be good for the farmers who would get better returns and for consumers who would have fresh organic products. Jason is aware that how customer's shop is changing and he wants to bring this change to how customers get their produce.

He could build a platform that lists farms and the produce available and then allows consumers to place orders or even visit the farm to get produce. Jason would charge a small monthly fees to farmers listed on the platform. Jason thinks he has a winning idea and now just needs funds to hire a software engineer to develop the platform.

Based on the case study, evaluate the farming industry **and** recommend if Jason should continue with his venture

Hint: The tool we use to evaluate an industry is the porter five forces tool